Sweden. Naydu Raghavan, an explosives expert with the LTTE, was in Singapore. Pushparaj, an LTTE operative who reportedly coordinated with Sivarasan's overseas contacts, was in France. And Peniyapann, reportedly a fundraiser for the LTTE, was in the UAE. Could it be that Sivarasan was seeking their help for his escape after Jaffna had ignored his calls for a boat? Having said that, Kanth felt that it was too early to deduce that Prabhakaran had removed the cover of protection from Sivarasan and gang, leaving them to fend for themselves.

'That he and Shubha have still managed to evade the SIT is nothing short of amazing,' he said.[16]

Anirudhya wrote in his next story, titled 'Rajiv Gandhi Assassination Probe Casts Its Net Wide',

> The flip side to that was [that] the carefully built network of over a decade was collapsing like a house of cards; the lynchpin of yesterday had now become a liability. Major LTTE establishments in Tamil Nadu had been wiped out, while there had been a rich haul of arms, explosives, high-powered communication gadgets and money. Also over 30 of their members were either dead or cooling their heels in prison. Little wonder that Sivarasan's SOS for a boat to Jaffna had failed to elicit a response. There was another apprehension that might have been keeping the Tigers from having him picked up from the Tamil Nadu coast. The Tigers probably feared that if Sivarasan was arrested or killed by the Indian or Sri Lankan security while being pulled out from India, the involvement of the LTTE in the killing of Rajiv would be established beyond doubt.[17]

But it was an IB report that rocked the SIT. It claimed that Sivarasan was actually not trying to escape, despite the manhunt launched to catch him—he was getting ready to strike at more VIPs. Both the VIPs were to pay a visit to the Prime Minister later in the month. Some of the assassins in custody revealed that Sivarasan was supposed to visit New Delhi and meet